

# Duncan Webb

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**Nova School of Business and Economics**  
Department of Economics  
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## Research Fields

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**Primary:** Development Economics; **Secondary:** Behavioural Economics

## Positions

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| <b>Nova School of Business and Economics, Lisbon</b><br><i>Assistant Professor of Economics</i>                        | 2025 —                                               |
| <b>Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL)</b><br><i>Affiliate</i>                                               | 2026 —                                               |
| <b>Princeton University</b><br><i>Postdoctoral Scholar in Economics</i>                                                | 2024-2025                                            |
| <b>Paris School of Economics (PSE)</b><br><i>Ph.D. in Economics</i>                                                    | 2019-2024<br>Supervisors: Karen Macours, Suanna Oh   |
| <b>Massachusetts Institute of Technology</b><br><i>Visiting Scholar in Economics</i>                                   | 2022-2023<br>Sponsors: Esther Duflo, Frank Schilbach |
| <b>University of California, Berkeley</b><br><i>Visiting Scholar in Economics</i>                                      | 2021<br>Sponsor: Supreet Kaur                        |
| <b>Paris School of Economics (PSE)</b> (summa cum laude)<br><i>Masters in Economics: Public Policy and Development</i> | 2017-2019                                            |
| <b>Oxford University</b> (1 <sup>st</sup> class)<br><i>BA Philosophy, Politics and Economics</i>                       | 2012-2015                                            |

## Working Papers

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Silence to Solidarity: How Communication About A Minority Affects Discrimination [[PDF](#)]

**Accepted, Journal of Political Economy**

*Winner of Weiss Family NEUDC Distinguished Paper 2023*

Menstrual Stigma and Human Capital: Experimental Evidence from Madagascar [[PDF](#)]

**CEPR Discussion Paper 21167, 2026**

*with Karen Macours and Julieta Vera Rueda*

Psychological Mechanisms for Measuring Preferences and Beliefs [[PDF](#)]

*with Evan Friedman and Suanna Oh*

## Publications

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Critical Periods in Cognitive and Socioemotional Development: Evidence from Weather Shocks in Indonesia [[PDF](#)]

**The Economic Journal, 2024**

COVID-19 spread, detection, and dynamics in Bogota, Colombia [[PDF](#)]

**Nature Communications, 2021**

with *Rachid Laajaj et al*

Understanding how socioeconomic inequalities drive inequalities in COVID-19 infections [[PDF](#)]

**Scientific Reports, 2022**

with *Rachid Laajaj, et al*

## Selected Works in Progress

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Parental Coaching to Improve Adolescent Smartphone Habits in Colombia

with *Janet Currie, Oscar Díaz, Juan Saavedra, Angela Guarín, & Frank Schilbach*

Stress, Stigma, and Learning in Madagascar

with *Karen Macours, Oscar Díaz, and Mariachiara Iannuzzi*

How Persistent Are the Impacts of Global Education and Health Interventions? Evidence from 1513 Meta-Analyses

with *Eva Vivalt*

AI-Assisted Screening and Health Care Demand in India

with *Patrick Agte and Pascaline Dupas*

Using AI to Evaluate the Robustness of Research in Economics

Rethinking Restrictive Masculinity Norms: Economic Disaffection and Young Men's Wellbeing in India

with *Seema Jayachandran*

## Professional service

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**Referee for:** *Quarterly Journal of Economics; American Economic Review: Insights; Journal of Political Economy: Micro; American Economic Journal: Applied Economics; Journal of Development Economics; Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization; World Development; Journal of Health Economics; Economics of Education Review*

## Employment

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Teaching Fellow, Econometrics (Graduate)

PSE, 2020-21

World Bank, Consultant to DIME

2018

Cancer Research UK – Digital Innovation Manager

2015-2017

## External presentations

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2025: *UC Berkeley, Duke, UCSD*

2024: *Harvard Economics Development Seminar, NBER Summer Institute, RookieFest (Northwestern University), LSE Inclusion Workshop, World Bank Gender Innovation Lab, CEPR Development Economics Symposium, CSAE, AEA LGBTQ+ Economics, PSE Scientific Council, EAYE-AM*

2023: *OxDEV, Advances with Field Experiments, NEUDC, CEPR Policy Forum, MIT Behavioural Lunch, MIT Development Lunch, International Conference on Development Economics (AFEDDEV)*

2022: *Berkeley Development Seminar, MIT Behavioural Lunch, MIT Development Lunch*

## Grants, Awards, Fellowships

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| FID (Funds for Innovation in Development), Stage 3 (w. Karen Macours & Oscar Díaz)                      | 2026      |
| Weiss Fund for Development Economics, Research Grant                                                    | 2026      |
| Weiss Fund for Development Economics, Research Grant (w. Arkadev Ghosh)                                 | 2026      |
| Weiss Fund for Development Economics, Research Grant (w. Nina Buchmann, Leticia Juarez & Sakib Mahmood) | 2026      |
| CGI Medium Grant (w. Seema Jayachandran)                                                                | 2026      |
| CGI Medium Grant (w. Patrick Agte & Pascaline Dupas)                                                    | 2026      |
| JPAL Learning for All Initiative (w. Janet Currie, Oscar Díaz, Juan Saavedra & Frank Schilbach)         | 2026      |
| GEM Incubation Fund                                                                                     | 2025      |
| Google.org, AI and health                                                                               | 2025      |
| JPAL Innovation in Governance Initiative                                                                | 2025      |
| French Association of Economic Sciences (AFSE) – Best PhD Prize Special Mention                         | 2025      |
| JPAL Learning for All Initiative                                                                        | 2025      |
| Open Philanthropy Research Grant                                                                        | 2025      |
| FID (Funds for Innovation in Development) (w. Karen Macours & Oscar Díaz)                               | 2024      |
| Weiss Fund for Development Economics, Research Grant                                                    | 2023      |
| Institute for Humane Studies, Conference Accelerator Grant                                              | 2023      |
| JPAL Crime and Violence Initiative, Research Grant                                                      | 2022      |
| Global Priorities Fellowship, Forethought Foundation                                                    | 2022-2023 |
| SurveyCTO Data Collection Research Grant                                                                | 2022      |
| Research Grant, EUR-PGSE                                                                                | 2022      |
| Research Grant, CEPREMAP                                                                                | 2022      |
| Grant, FID (Funds for Innovation in Development) (w. Karen Macours & Julieta Vera)                      | 2021      |
| JPAL Post-Primary Education Initiative (with Karen Macours and Julieta Vera)                            | 2021      |
| Research Grant, CEPREMAP                                                                                | 2021      |
| Research Grant, EUR-PGSE (with Suanna Oh and Evan Friedman)                                             | 2021      |
| Research Grant, CEPREMAP (with Karen Macours and Julieta Vera)                                          | 2021      |
| Ecole Doctorale 465 Full Funding                                                                        | 2019-2022 |
| PhD Scholarship (2 highest performing students in Masters)                                              | 2018      |
| Eiffel Excellence Scholarship                                                                           | 2017-2019 |
| Exhibition Scholarship, BA in Philosophy, Politics, Economics                                           | 2015      |

## Skills and Interests

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**Languages:** English (native), French (fluent), Spanish (beginner)

**Software:** Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, SurveyCTO, oTree

**Other interests:** jazz music, meditation, Effective Altruism

## References

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**Professor Karen Macours**

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**Professor Suanna Oh**

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**Professor Frank Schilbach**

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[fschilb@mit.edu](mailto:fschilb@mit.edu)

**Professor Abhijit Banerjee**

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